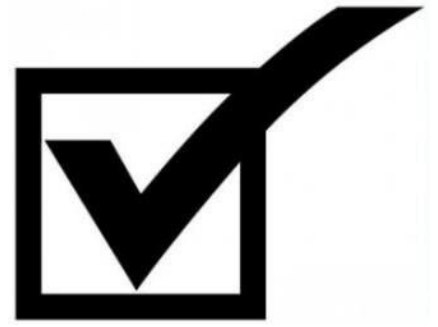




Contemporary Issues

(530)

STATE 2025
PRELIMINARY

TOTAL POINTS _____ (100 points)

Preparation Time: 10 minutes

Description

Demonstrate communication skills in arranging, organizing, and effectively presenting information orally without prior knowledge of the topic.

No materials or previously prepared notes will be allowed into the preparation or presentation room with the contestant.

JUDGING PROCEDURE

- The contestant will draw two (2) different business topics and will select either one. The topics may deal with Business Professionals of America, office situations, the business world, etc.
- The contestant will be provided ten (10) minutes to develop the topic. Notes will be made on the note cards provided by the event proctor. No advisor contact will be allowed between the time of receiving the topic and the delivery.
- Cell phones may not be used in the preparation room.
- Contestants will be introduced by contestant number. **Contestants may continue to wear their name badges.**
- Contestants will present before a panel of judges and timekeeper.
- The length of the speech will be no less than three (3) minutes and no more than five (5) minutes.
- The contestant will be given warnings via flash cards when there are two (2) minutes remaining and when there is one (1) minute remaining during the speaking time.
- The speech will be stopped at five (5) minutes.
- No time is allotted for judges' questions.
- Contestants should be dismissed upon completion of their speech.
- **There can be no ties in the top ten (10) contestants.** It is the responsibility of the judges to break any ties.
- Administrator will fill out ranking sheet prior to dismissing the judges.
- If more than one (1) section is necessary, finalists will be determined by selecting an equal number from each section.
- Give administrator all Judges' Rating Sheets, Judge Evaluation Sheets, and contest materials.
- No audience is allowed in the contest room.

Please double-check and verify all scores!

TOPICS:

What ideas do you have to improve access to resources for low-income families?

How has technology changed the way people work remotely?

What are the effects of sleep deprivation on academic performance?

What are the benefits and challenges of starting a small business in today's economy?

Should minimum wage laws be determined at the federal or state level? Why?

What are some ways individuals can protect themselves from the effects of inflation?

How can businesses promote workplace diversity and inclusion to enhance productivity and innovation?

Should COVID-19 protective measures still be in place?